

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Finding Reasoning Paths :

1 . Chronic sadness , hopelessness , and suicidal ideations -> Major Depressive Disorder (MDD).

2 . Difficulty making decisions and feeling cursed -> Diminished capacity -> Major Depressive Disorder .

3 . Guilt over past problems and suicidal ideations -> Suicidal ideations -> Major Depressive Disorder .

4 . Diminished capacity and hopelessness -> Symptom overlap with psychotic disorders or severe depression -> Major Depressive Disorder .

5 . Hopelessness and despair -> Suicidal ideations -> Major Depressive Disorder .

Reasoning Process :

1 . **Chronic sadness and hopelessness**: The patient reports feeling sad for as long as he can remember , describes his life as " curse ," and expresses hopelessness . These symptoms are hallmark features of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD), particularly the persistent and enduring nature of his sadness .

2 . **Suicidal ideations and guilt**: The patient has had worsening suicidal ideations over the past two weeks , which aligns with the specifier " pursuing suicide ideation " in MDD . Additionally , he expresses guilt over past problems , which is a common feature of MDD and may contribute to his emotional state .

3 . **Difficulty making decisions**: The patient has difficulty making decisions , which could indicate diminished capacity . Diminished capacity is a cognitive symptom often associated with severe depression , as it can impair a person 's ability to function and make choices .

4 . **Hopelessness and despair**: The patient describes feeling hopeless , as if his life is cursed , and experiences despair . These symptoms are consistent with the affective features of MDD and are not characteristic of psychotic disorders or other conditions .

5 . **Exclusion of psychotic features**: While the patient expresses hopelessness and despair , there is no evidence of hallucinations , delusions , or other psychotic symptoms . His suicidal ideations are not delusional but rather proportional to his depression .

6 . **Exclusion of other conditions**: The patient does not exhibit symptoms of dementia (e .g . , memory impairment or confusion) , psychosis (e .g . , hallucinations or delusions) , or anxiety disorders . His primary symptoms are consistent with MDD .

Conclusion :

The patient is most likely experiencing symptoms of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD), characterized by chronic sadness , hopelessness , and suicidal ideations . While he may also exhibit diminished capacity due to his depression , there is no evidence of psychotic features or other conditions that would support an alternate diagnosis . Therefore , the most appropriate conclusion is that the patient has Major Depressive Disorder .

</think>

<answer>

The patient is at risk for double depression .

</answer>

1.5

1.0

0.5

0.0

-0.5

-1.0

-1.5